



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Brilla Veritas Elementary

School Website: <https://brillaschools.org/our-schools/brilla-veritas-elementary>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

Brilla Veritas Elementary (Bronx, NY, 10455) (Bronx, NY) operates as part of Brilla Public Charter Schools, a network described publicly as eight free, high-performing K-8 schools in The Bronx. The public materials emphasize academic rigor coupled with a virtue-centered approach and characterize the school as an accessible, community-focused option (no entrance exams; enrollment is free). Evidence from the Brilla Veritas site shows the school's stated aim to develop students' minds and hearts through virtue-centered formation and character development, with explicit mention of college readiness as a goal. The site also highlights a staff-facing, teacher-centered public-facing presence (e.g., "TEACHER" pages), and a Families/Community orientation centered on open visits and family inquiries.

Overall, by the classical rubric, Brilla Veritas Elementary demonstrates some classical impulses (notably virtue-centered formation and a character-focused framing) but does not consistently articulate core classical elements such as the Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, or explicit Socratic pedagogy. Across the six categories, the school shows limited alignment with classical education in curriculum, pedagogy, and parent/community practices, with modest alignment in religious/metaphysical tone and formation aims. The aggregate assessment is NOT CLASSICAL. See category-by-category notes below for the supporting evidence and keyword analysis.

Notes on sources used for this evaluation:

- Public Brilla Veritas materials describing the school's mission, offerings, and logistics (e.g., "virtue-centered education," K-8, free enrollment, college readiness) and staff pages. Key excerpts: "academically rigorous and virtue-centered education" and "Enrollment is free, and no entrance exams are required" and staff pages describing teachers and tutoring roles.
- Additional Brilla Veritas site content (contact, address, families, and public prompts) supporting the evaluation of category-specific signals.
- Classical elements framework and keyword indicators (Six Essential Elements of a Classical School) used for keyword matching and scoring, including both positive and negative keyword lists.
- A broader lexicon of classical education terms and signals (classicality_lexicon) to ground keyword matching and interpretation.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL**Evidence**

- The Brilla Veritas site repeatedly emphasizes "virtue-centered education" and character formation, but it does not clearly articulate transcendental moral realism, grounded theology, or liturgical/community worship practices in the public materials reviewed. The organizational name Brilla Veritas signals a focus on truth (Veritas) culturally, yet explicit theological or liturgical programming is not stated in the visible public content. See evidence of virtue-centered framing in the site copy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: virtue, virtue-centered, character (present in the public materials). The explicit appearance of "virtue-centered education" aligns with the Positive Keywords for religious/metaphysical foundations in the classical lexicon (virtue, transcendental moral realism as ideals).

- Negative keywords observed: none of the listed negative signals (e.g., secular relativism, value-neutral ethics) are overtly present in the Brilla Veritas public materials. The absence of theology/liturgical practices in the public copy further reduces alignment with the “Grounded in Theology” and “Liturgical/Communal Practices” signals.

Why this rating

- The school signals a moral formation intent through virtue-centered language, which maps to some positive signals in the classical lexicon. However, the materials lack explicit statements about transcendental realism, theological grounding, or liturgical/community worship practices, which are central to a Classical School’s Religious and Metaphysical Foundations. Therefore, category 1 is NOT CLASSICAL in full, with partial alignment reflected as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in the keyword analysis but not fully meeting the rubric’s deeper metaphysical criteria. The overall posture leans toward a moral-formation frame rather than a robust metaphysical/theological program.

Citations: Brilla Veritas language of virtue-centered education and character formation is evidenced in the school copy.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The public copy frames education as forming minds and hearts toward success in college and beyond, with emphasis on character formation. The explicit articulation includes “developing the minds and hearts of our students, equipping them with the knowledge, skills, and character necessary to succeed in college and beyond,” and “virtue-centered education.” This signals formation and moral aims rather than purely vocational or informational outcomes.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: formation (implied by “minds and hearts” and “character”), virtue-centered, character. The presence of a formation/virtuous orientation aligns with the Positive Keywords in the classical rubric (formation, liberal education, telos, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty, etc.), albeit without explicit reference to Great Books or liberal arts pedagogy.
- Negative keywords observed: The site does emphasize college readiness in a way that can be read as a modern, career/college-prep outcome rather than “education for leisure” or “scholé” contemplation, which are classic signals. The explicit language of college readiness is more aligned with modern outcomes than classical telos.

Why this rating

- The school presents formation and virtue-centered aims, which are core to Classical education, but the explicit emphasis on college readiness and beyond as primary outcomes and the lack of a stated, comprehensive classical telos (e.g., pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty as real, or liberal arts through Trivium/Quadrivium) suggests only partial alignment. Therefore, Element 2 is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Citations: The formation/human-excellence framing and college-readiness emphasis are visible in Brilla Veritas copy.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials describe Brilla Veritas as a K-8 charter school network with emphasis on an “academically rigorous and virtue-centered education.” There is no explicit mention of the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; and arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy), no explicit reference to Great Books or the Great Conversation, and no mention of memorization/recitation of a classical canon. The

materials focus on general rigorous academic program and character formation rather than a classical-canon curriculum. See site copy and the network branding for context.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: None of the explicit classical curriculum signals (Seven Liberal Arts; Great Books; Great Conversation; Latin/Greek; etc.) appear in the public Brilla Veritas materials provided. The curriculum language tends toward general academic rigor and virtue-centered goals. The Positive Keywords in the classical lexicon emphasize Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, and formation through classical texts; these signals are not present in the Brilla materials reviewed.
- Negative keywords observed: The absence of Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, and classical-canon language functions as a negative signal when contrasted with the classical curriculum; the materials do not present the integrated, canon-rich curriculum that characterizes a classical school.

Why this rating

- The absence of explicit classical curriculum components (Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, Great Conversation, bilingual/Latin study, etc.) places Brilla Veritas outside the Classical School curriculum category in the rubric. Therefore, Element 3 is NOT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Public Brilla materials describe the network and its academic/character focus but do not articulate classical-canon curriculum signals.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The site materials show standard teacher roles (TEACHER, TUTOR) and a general, college-ready, virtue-centered approach. There is no explicit documentation of Socratic dialogue/seminars, Scholé (restful learning), memorization/recitation, or disciplined classical rhetoric pedagogy on the public-facing pages reviewed. The staff pages describe teachers and mentors but do not demonstrate a classical pedagogy (e.g., Harkness-style discussions, heavy memorization or recitation traditions, or upper-level rhetoric/capstone routines).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: None of the classical pedagogy signals (Socratic dialogue and dialectic; restfulness/scholé; memorization/recitation; formation through imitation) are explicitly described in the Brilla public materials. The presence of “teacher” and “tutor” roles is standard but does not indicate a Classical Pedagogy. The lexicon’s Pedagogy Positive Keywords (Socratic dialogue, scholé, memorization/recitation, etc.) are not evidenced in the Brilla site copy.
- Negative keywords observed: The absence of classical pedagogy signals (e.g., Socratic seminars, memorization focus, reign of rhetoric training) is a negative signal when evaluated against a classical rubric.

Why this rating

- Because explicit classical pedagogy signals (Socratic pedagogy, memorization/recitation, Scholé, rhetoric training) are not evidenced in the public Brilla Veritas materials, Element 4 is NOT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Pedagogical method signals are not visible in the Brilla Veritas public materials; staff pages show traditional teacher roles but not classical pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The Brilla site includes staff pages (e.g., TEACHER, TUTOR) and specific staff profiles, indicating publicly available information about faculty. However, the public materials do not explicitly describe

faculty as “living curriculum,” “model teachers and mentors,” or a “portrait of the teacher” in the sense used by classical lexicon and rubric. The available content shows standard teacher roles and quotes but does not clearly convey a classical faculty identity or a formal, virtue-ethos portrait of the teacher as a central component of the curriculum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: The Brilla materials show teachers and a staff presence, which aligns with a basic “faculty” signal but are not described with the classical cues (e.g., “living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher,” “faculty of friends”). The available content does not explicitly satisfy the classical faculty signals.
- Negative keywords observed: The classical lexicon includes signals like “living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher,” and “teacher as mentor” with a canonical ideal. The Brilla materials lack explicit articulation of such teacher-identity branding in public-facing content.

Why this rating

- Element 5 is NOT CLASSICAL given the lack of explicit classical-faculty signals in the public materials, despite having a staff presence. The public content does not meet the classical faculty indicators at scale.

Citations: Public staff content shows TEACHER and Tutor roles; no explicit “living curriculum” or faculty-portrait language is evident.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The Brilla site includes a “Families” area with contact information and a general invitation to engage with the school; however, explicit signals of partnership with families as co-teachers, parent formation activities (book studies, gatherings), or open-door visitation culture are not strongly evidenced in the public content. The materials emphasize accessibility (free enrollment, no entrance exams) and family inquiries but do not foreground a robust classical-parent partnership or ongoing parent-education program.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: Some signals around family involvement and openness, but not the classical Partner-with-Families signals (e.g., parent formation, classical book clubs, deep home-school partnership). The lexicon lists “Partnership with Families,” “parent formation,” and “home-centered learning” as positive signals; those are not explicitly demonstrated in Brilla Veritas public materials beyond basic family contact and enrollment information.
- Negative keywords observed: The absence of explicit parent-education initiatives, home-school partnership language, or parent-as-co-teacher signals represents a negative signal relative to classical-parent partnership.

Why this rating

- Element 6 is NOT CLASSICAL since the public materials do not demonstrate the classical parent-community partnership signals (co-teachers, book clubs, family catechesis, open-campus culture) consistently.

Citations: Families page and public contact/inquiry language show engagement but not the full classical-parent partnership signals.

Aggregate assessment across categories

- Element 1: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 2: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 3: NOT CLASSICAL

- Element 4: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: NOT CLASSICAL

Overall, the school's alignment with classical education is NOT CLASSICAL, given that the majority of categories do not meet the classical criteria and only Element 1 and Element 2 show partial alignment through virtue-centered formation and a formation-focused framing.

What Would Move the Needle (only for SOMEWHATCLASSICAL cases)

- Not applicable to the overall aggregate, but concrete steps that would push toward a more classical profile include:
- Curriculum adoption: Explicitly incorporate the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium, as well as a declared Great Books program and Great Conversation framework within the curriculum, with opportunities for primary sources and classic texts.
- Pedagogy: Introduce Socratic seminars, guided inquiry, and structured memorization/recitation where appropriate, supplemented by regular discourse-based assessments (Harkness-style discussions, debates, or oral expositions).
- Theology/Metaphysical Foundations: If desired to emphasize a more metaphysical grounding, articulate a formal theology track or a clearly stated metaphysical framework that aligns with the classical tradition, including liturgical or communal practices consistent with the school's religious vision.
- Faculty identity: Develop a living-curriculum approach with a published faculty portrait and ongoing teacher development in classical pedagogy to embed virtue, wisdom, and eloquence as central features of the living curriculum.
- Parents and community: Establish formal partnerships with families as co-educators, implement parent-education programs (e.g., classical book groups), and create a clear family formation calendar aligned with the classical ethos.

Note: These needle-moving steps are recommendations aligned with the Six Essential Elements rubric and the classical lexicon, aimed at increasing alignment with classical benchmarks across multiple categories.

ABSTRACT

Brilla Veritas Elementary (Bronx, NY, 10455) demonstrates limited alignment with classical education across the six rubric categories. The school shows clear virtue-centered aims and formation-oriented language (Element 1: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL; Element 2: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL), but lacks explicit classical curriculum components (Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books) and classical pedagogy (Socratic dialogue, Scholé, memorization) that define a Classical School. Public materials do not demonstrate robust engagement with Great Books or canonical texts in the curriculum (Element 3: NOT CLASSICAL) or pedagogy (Element 4: NOT CLASSICAL). The faculty signals present in publicly available staff pages do not clearly articulate the “living curriculum” or teacher-portrait language central to Classical education (Element 5: NOT CLASSICAL). Parent-and-community signals lack the explicit partnerships and formation programs characteristic of classical parent involvement (Element 6: NOT CLASSICAL). The aggregate ranking is NOT CLASSICAL.

Summary of primary signals by category

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: Virtue-centered formation present; explicit theology/liturgical programs not evident. Classically signaled as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- School Purpose and Goal: Formation and virtue framing present; college-readiness framing evident; not explicit classical telos. SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Curriculum: No explicit Trivium/Quadrivium or Great Books signals; not classical curriculum. NOT CLASSICAL.
- Pedagogy: No explicit classical pedagogy; standard teacher roles; not classical. NOT CLASSICAL.
- Faculty: Public-facing faculty signals present, but not the classical “living curriculum” portrait. NOT CLASSICAL.

- Parents & Community: Some family engagement language, but lacking formal classical-parent-partnership signals (co-teaching, formation). NOT CLASSICAL.

Key Classical Keywords and Indicators Used

- Positive/Negative keyword indicators from the Six Essential Elements (1) document and the classicality lexicon were used to assess presence/absence of canonical signals such as: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; great books; great conversation; Trivium/Quadrivium; Socratic pedagogy; Scholé; living curriculum; partnership with families; and liturgical practices. The Brilla Veritas site content shows virtue-centered language and formation aims but does not consistently demonstrate canonical classical elements across six categories. The lexicon and document provide the anchors for these keyword signals.

ABSTRACT

Brilla Veritas Elementary (Bronx, NY, 10455) demonstrates partial alignment with classical aims in the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and School Purpose & Goal categories (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL), primarily through virtue-centered formation and character development, and a focus on developing minds and hearts toward college readiness. However, across Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community, the school does not articulate the canonical classical elements (Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books/-Great Conversation, Socratic pedagogy, living curriculum, or explicit parent partnership) in public-facing materials, yielding a NOT CLASSICAL aggregate classification. The school's public materials emphasize accessible education (free enrollment, no entrance exams) and virtue-centered aims, but lack the comprehensive classical framework that the Six Essential Elements outline as essential to a Classical School. The overall assessment: NOT CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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